MAKING SPACE TOOLKIT · 01

Meeting-in-a-Box

A 20-minute, human-centred workload conversation for any team meeting

Purpose Identify one recurring workload pressure, protect professional judgement, and agree one small, testable improvement.

BEFORE THE MEETING

- Print one A3 MAKING SPACE Canvas (Toolkit 02) per group.
- Bring pens and a timer. Choose a facilitator and a note-taker.
- **Do not enter identifiable pupil or staff information into AI tools.**

20-MINUTE FACILITATION PLAN

TIME	STAGE	PROMPT / OUTPUT
0-3 min	SPOT	Each person names a recurring workload friction. Choose one specific issue to explore.
3-6 min	QUESTION	What outcome is this work meant to achieve? Who needs it? What happens if we stop?
6-9 min	PROTECT	What requires empathy, relationships, context, safeguarding or professional judgement?
9-15 min	RETHINK	Could we remove, simplify, redesign, automate, AI-assist - or leave it alone? Check risks and existing systems.
15-18 min	RECLAIM	If the change helps, what human work or wellbeing will the freed capacity support? How will we protect it?
18-20 min	COMMIT	Agree a small pilot, named owner, baseline, review date and success measures.

Required output: one defined problem, a small pilot, a named owner, a review date and an intention for reclaimed capacity.

FACILITATOR QUESTIONS

- **SPOT:** Who experiences this friction, and when?
- **QUESTION:** What outcome matters? Could the task stop?
- **PROTECT:** What requires human judgement, relationships or care?
- **RETHINK:** Remove, simplify, redesign, automate, AI-assist or leave alone?
- **RECLAIM:** What will we intentionally make space for?

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BEFORE PILOTING

Check necessity, privacy, safeguarding, accuracy, equity, human oversight, and whether workload simply shifts to another person.

30-DAY FOLLOW-THROUGH

WEEK 1	WEEKS 2-3	BY DAY 30
Baseline and owner agreed.	Small, safe test with a small group.	Review workload, quality and reclaimed capacity. Adopt, adjust or stop.

THREE EVALUATION QUESTIONS

1. Did work or friction actually reduce?
2. Was quality and professional judgement protected?
3. Was reclaimed capacity protected, rather than filled with more work?

Informed by: **EEF** Workload Review · **DfE** Conversation Guide for Workload and Wellbeing · **DfE** Staff Workload Survey

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